

TRANSMITTAL LETTERS & MEMOS

Tauqeer Anjum

Transmittal Letter

A brief letter or note sent with a document or parcel to explain the contents

Transmittal Letter/Memo

A **MEMO** (or **letter**) of **transmittal** acts to.

- Officially Announce the release of the report.
- Give the reader the background necessary to understand the report's importance.
- Establish the relationship between the writer and the reader.

Transmittal Letter/Memo

The letter of transmittal presents your report to its intended audience (in a book this section would be called the preface).

Think of the letter of transmittal as the conversation that you would have with your audience (client, boss, etc.) if you were handing the report directly to them.

Your letter should have a personal but professional tone to it.

Transmittal Letter/Memo

□ Introduction

- Title (in italics) and the purpose of the report
- Who the report was written for
- Authorization (who authorized the project, when)
- Show how the report has met your objectives or how your objectives have changed

Transmittal Letter/Memo

Introduction Example:

The attached report, requested by the Flagstaff City Council in a letter to Goldman-Lyon & Associates dated October 20, describes the economic impact of the Coconino Industrial Park on the city of Flagstaff. We believe you will find the results of this study useful in evaluating future development of industrial parks within the city limits.

Transmittal Letter/Memo

□ **Body**

- Briefly mention methods (How did you arrive at your results. i.e. did you conduct a survey, interview leaders in the field, research competitors)
- Give an overview of your results, point out the main results or point out surprising results/findings
- Focus on conclusions of final report (What were your major findings?)
- Focus on summary of recommendations (What are your 3 most important recommendations?)

Transmittal Letter/Memo

□ *Body Example*

This study was designed to examine economic impact in three areas:

- Current and projected tax and other revenues accruing to the city from Coconino Industrial Park
- Current and projected employment generated by the park
- Indirect effects on local employment, income, and economic growth

Primary research consisted of interviews with 15 Coconino Industrial Park (CIP) tenants and managers, in addition to a 2010 survey of over 5,000 CIP employees. Secondary research sources included the Annual Budget of the City of Flagstaff, county and state tax records, government publications, periodicals, books, and online resources. Results of this research discussed more fully in this report, indicate that Coconino Industrial Park exerts a significant beneficial influence on the Flagstaff metropolitan economy.

Transmittal Letter/Memo

▣ **Conclusion**

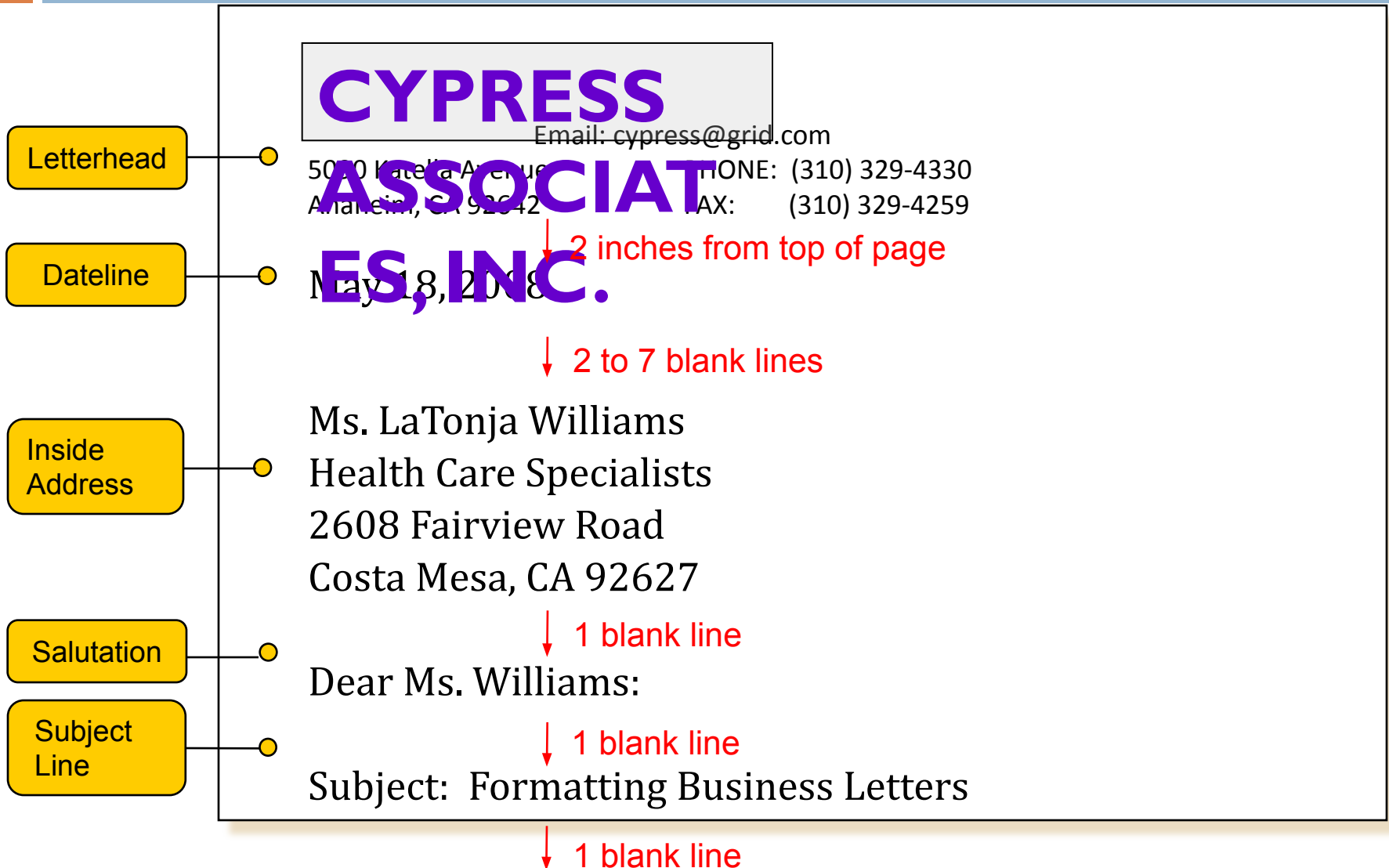
- ▣ Acknowledge assistance you received (Was someone in the client's company particularly useful? Did you have assistance from a community member? Did you seek the assistance of faculty or other personnel on campus?)
- ▣ Offer to assist with interpretation
- ▣ Offer to assist with further work (For example, are you willing to help develop the website you proposed your client developed?)
- ▣ Make a call to action (recommendations)
- ▣ Add personal comments (goodwill close)

Transmittal LetterMemo

□ *Conclusion Example*

We would be pleased to discuss this report and its conclusions with you at your request. My firm and I thank you for your confidence in selecting our company to prepare this comprehensive report.

Formatting Business Letters



Formatting Business Letters

At your request, this letter illustrates and explains business letter formatting in a nutshell. The most important points to remember are these:

1. Set margins between 1 inch; most word processing programs automatically set margins at 1 inch.
2. Start the date 2 inches from the top edge of the paper or 1 blank line below the letterhead, whichever position is lower.
3. Allow about 5 lines after the date—more lines for shorter letters and fewer lines for longer ones.

Numbered list
for improved
readability

One blank line
between
paragraphs

The two most popular letter styles are block and modified block. Block style, with all lines beginning at the left, causes the least trouble. In modified block-style letters,

Formatting Business Letters

the date and closing lines start at the center.

For both styles the complimentary close is followed by three blank lines before the writer's signature. Reference initials and enclosure notations, if used, appear in the lower left corner, as shown below.

So that you can see additional styles, I'm sending our office style guide. I certainly hope this material is helpful to you and your assistants, Ms. Williams.

Complimentary
Closing

Sincerely,

3-4 blank lines

Printed Name
and Title

Sharon Montoya

Sharon Montoya
Executive Director

Team 5A
Ohio University College of Business
Copeland Hall
Athens, Ohio 45701

555.555.5555
fax: 555.555.5555
juniorpartners@copelandassociates.com

February 2, 2011

Senior Partners
Copeland & Associates
123 Success Road
Athens, Ohio 45701

Dear Senior Partners:

Subject: Analysis of Coca-Cola

As requested by the senior partners of Copeland and Associates, our team has performed an analysis of Coca-Cola and prepared a report. The report contains details about the current state and future prospects of Coca-Cola. Through analysis of the current state and future prospect, we were able to identify the keys success factors and challenges Coca-Cola will face over the next five years.

The key success factors and challenges for Coca-Cola were created with the consideration of the following criteria:

- The current state of the company.
- The future prospects of the company.
- A summary of company, industry, and competitive information.
- Key strategic issues the company is facing.

Provided within the report are appendices to support our key success factors and challenges, including an analysis of Coca-Cola's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats (SWOT). The appendices also include a competitive strength assessment, an analysis of the company's operational effectiveness, and forecasted financial performance. Each of these items was used to aid us in the identification of the key success factors and challenges Coca-Cola faces.

Thank you for the opportunity to analyze Coca-Cola. We appreciate you allowing us to identify Coca-Cola's key success factors and challenges for the next five years. If you need further assistance with the information in this analysis or future projects, please contact us at 555-555-5555 or email us at juniorpartners@copelandassociates.com.

Sincerely,

Team 5A
Name 1
Name 3

Name 2
Name 4

Name 5

January 12, 2012

City Council
City of Flagstaff
211 West Aspen Avenue
Flagstaff, AZ 86001

Dear Council Members:

Subject: Economic Impact of Coconino Industrial Park

The attached report, requested by the Flagstaff City Council in a letter to Goldman-Lyon & Associates dated October 20, describes the economic impact of the Coconino Industrial Park on the city of Flagstaff. We believe you will find the results of this study useful in evaluating future development of industrial parks within the city limits.

This study was designed to examine economic impact in three areas:

- Current and projected tax and other revenues accruing to the city from Coconino Industrial Park
- Current and projected employment generated by the park
- Indirect effects on local employment, income, and economic growth

Primary research consisted of interviews with 15 Coconino Industrial Park (CIP) tenants and managers, in addition to a 2010 survey of over 5,000 CIP employees. Secondary research sources included the Annual Budget of the City of Flagstaff, county and state tax records, government publications, periodicals, books, and online resources. Results of this research discussed more fully in this report, indicate that Coconino Industrial Park exerts a significant beneficial influence on the Flagstaff metropolitan economy.

We would be pleased to discuss this report and its conclusions with you at your request. My firm and I thank you for your confidence in selecting our company to prepare this comprehensive report.

Sincerely,

Sylvia Hernandez

Sylvia Hernandez
Senior Research Consultant

SMH: mef
Attachment

Formatting Business Memos

Date: May 18, 2008

↓ 1 blank line

To: LaTonja Williams, title

↓ 1 blank line

From: Sharon Montoya (include initials of printed copy)

↓ 1 blank line

Subject: Formatting Business Letters

↓ 2 blank lines

At your request, this memo illustrates and explains business memo formatting in a nutshell. The most important points to remember are these:

Date: February 2, 2011

To: Prof. 1
Prof. 2
Prof. 3
Prof. 4

From: Team 5A
Name 1
Name 2
Name 3
Name 4
Name 5

Subject: Analysis of Coca-Cola

As requested by the senior partners of Copeland and Associates, our team has performed an analysis of Coca-Cola and prepared a report. The report contains details about the current state and future prospects of Coca-Cola. Through analysis of the current state and future prospect, we were able to identify the keys success factors and challenges Coca-Cola will face over the next five years.

The key success factors and challenges for Coca-Cola were created with the consideration of the following criteria:

- The current state of the company.
- The future prospects of the company.
- A summary of company, industry, and competitive information.
- Key strategic issues the company is facing.

Provided within the report are appendices to support our key success factors and challenges, including an analysis of Coca-Cola's strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats (SWOT). The appendices also include a competitive strength assessment, an analysis of the company's operational effectiveness, and forecasted financial performance. Each of these items was used to aid us in the identification of the key success factors and challenges Coca-Cola faces.

Thank you for the opportunity to analyze Coca-Cola. We appreciate you allowing us to identify Coca-Cola's key success factors and challenges for the next five years. If you need further assistance with the information in this analysis or future projects, please contact us at 555-555-5555 or email us at juniorpartners@copelandassociates.com.

Date: January 12, 2012

To: Flagstaff City Council Members

From: Sylvia Hernandez, Del Rio Industrial Consultants 

Subject: Economic Impact of Coconino Industrial Park

The attached report, requested by the Flagstaff City Council in a letter to Goldman-Lyon & Associates dated October 20, describes the economic impact of the Coconino Industrial Park on the city of Flagstaff. We believe you will find the results of this study useful in evaluating future development of industrial parks within the city limits.

This study was designed to examine economic impact in three areas:

- Current and projected tax and other revenues accruing to the city from Coconino Industrial Park
- Current and projected employment generated by the park
- Indirect effects on local employment, income, and economic growth

Primary research consisted of interviews with 15 Coconino Industrial Park (CIP) tenants and managers, in addition to a 2010 survey of over 5,000 CIP employees. Secondary research sources included the Annual Budget of the City of Flagstaff, county and state tax records, government publications, periodicals, books, and online resources. Results of this research discussed more fully in this report, indicate that Coconino Industrial Park exerts a significant beneficial influence on the Flagstaff metropolitan economy.

We would be pleased to discuss this report and its conclusions with you at your request. My firm and I thank you for your confidence in selecting our company to prepare this comprehensive report.